

Chapter 150_1 - The Eve

Ning Fuyi then turned her around, leaned close to her ear, and whispered something softly.

Chu Qingqiu's expression visibly turned to astonishment. Her dark eyebrows rose and fell, gripping Ning Fuyi's wrist.

"I never asked about your affairs. I thought you..."

"Did you think that for these thirty years, I was truly just surviving under Penglai's very nose?" Ning Fuyi smiled. "I never spoke of it—first because you never asked, and second because this matter is indeed significant. I was afraid you would blame me."

"The immortal realm ultimately despises the demon realm, so, will you blame me?" Ning Fuyi lowered her head.

Chu Qingqiu's hand tightened, then loosened and dropped: "How could I blame you?"

"By now, I've long lost that obsession from before. After all, no matter how high one's position, one must admit their thoughts might be wrong."

Ning Fuyi stared into her eyes for a moment, pursing her lips: "You're so good."

"You're the good one. There will never be anyone like you again." Chu Qingqiu stepped forward to embrace her waist, burying her body in her arms with a sigh. "How fortunate I am to have your love."

"Perhaps it's the blessing from when you showed mercy and didn't kill me back then." Ning Fuyi rubbed her head with her chin, earning a light slap.

Ning Fuyi pretended to be hurt but didn't dodge.

After embracing for a while, she spoke again: "I won't let you bear all this alone, so I may need to leave for a few days."

Chu Qingqiu couldn't help gripping the leather belt at her waist, creasing it, before answering after a long pause: "Good."

She mocked herself inwardly—now just leaving for a few days already made her reluctant. If she had known that loving someone deeply would bring such great changes, she would have...

Never mind, she would still choose the same.

"I'll wait for you," Chu Qingqiu said.

Ning Fuyi's eyes curved with a smile.

Ning Fuyi didn't tell anyone, but quietly took Jiuying and left Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate.

On the way to the Western Wasteland, Jiuying remained silent the entire time. She had been like this these past few days—though her actions were still as usual, she was indeed speaking much less.

Ning Fuyi guessed that Qiu Yi's death had somewhat impacted her heart, but she couldn't express it, or perhaps even she herself only half-understood it.

Against the backdrop of flowing clouds behind them, Jiuying's silent silhouette standing on the sword was somewhat dejected.

"Are you alright?" Ning Fuyi asked. "I originally didn't want to involve you again, but it's not good for you to brood alone either."

Jiuying was pulled from her silence by her words, so she raised her eyelashes, her red lips curving slightly: "What's wrong with me?"

Ning Fuyi opened her mouth but didn't know what to say. Though she knew Qiu Yi's feelings, she couldn't fathom Jiuying's, so she changed the subject: "Have you visited Ping'an¹ these past few days?"

"Every day." Jiuying lazily threw her outer robe behind her. "It doesn't look like a qilin at all, just has brute strength."

Ning Fuyi laughed: "After all, it can't be considered a true qilin, but fortunately its lifespan follows yours. After living for over thirty years, it's still in its prime."

"That's true." After Jiuying finished speaking, she fell silent again.

Ning Fuyi was racking her brains thinking of what to say to her when Jiuying spoke: "You're taking me back to the demon realm to gather demon troops?"

"Yes." Ning Fuyi said, her expression calm. "When I rebuilt the Demon Cave, it was originally for the day I could contend with Penglai. I just didn't have time to lay low and bide my time—no one could predict that Penglai would become the enemy of the six realms so quickly."

"Have you thought it through? Once the demon army emerges, you'll be completely bound with demons in the world's eyes, and no amount of washing will make it clean." Jiuying swayed her body to avoid a mass of white clouds.

"When lives are at stake, why care about such things?" Ning Fuyi smiled at her.

Jiuying nodded in agreement: "Trying to make immortals and demons share a common enemy—you're still the first in history."

"Defending the six realms is everyone's responsibility," Ning Fuyi said with a grin.

They spent a day reaching the Western Wasteland, then entered the demon realm through the sandstorm. It had been a while since they returned, and everything in the demon realm was as usual.

Perhaps because the territory ruled by the Demon Cave was heavily guarded with few fights or bullying, the once empty world now had many demons and monsters wandering about.

Ning Fuyi had already changed to her demon realm appearance. When they saw her, these demons scattered to both sides, consciously making way and lowering their heads to wait for her to pass.

Ning Fuyi nodded to them, then walked past the countless skulls hanging at the Demon Cave entrance into the interior. From afar, she saw Shangchou turn into smoke and approach, condensing into human form before her.

"Demon Lord," he said, kneeling on one knee with two other black-armored demons, bowing in respect.

"Rise," Ning Fuyi said with lowered eyes. Her gaze swept over the dark Demon Cave as she asked directly, "How many people can we use now?"

Shangchou was startled but quickly answered: "Reporting to the Demon Lord, excluding those who just recently pledged to the Demon Cave, there are two thousand six hundred and forty-three in total."

Thousands of demons and monsters—not few, but not many either, especially when facing Penglai and the fallen demons and monsters wreaking havoc. The more people, the better the chances of victory.

"Gather them and have them ready at any time. Also, have Xi Que and Han Ya invite those demons who have publicly submitted to my Demon Cave. Meet at Wuchang Cave² in half an hour."

"Yes," Shangchou bowed.

Footnotes:

1. **Ping'an (平安)** - The name of Jiuying's pet qilin, meaning "peace" or "safety"
2. **Wuchang Cave (无常洞)** - Literally "Impermanence Cave," a place in the demon realm used for important gatherings or battles